



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Heritage Christian Academy
School Website: <https://heritagechristiansc.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Heritage Christian Academy (Lexington, SC 29072) presents a classical Christian program with clear religious foundations, a grammar-logic-rhetoric curriculum structure, visible faculty engagement, and active parental involvement. Public materials on the school site emphasize a Christ-centered worldview, integration of Scripture across disciplines, and a Trivium-based sequence (grammar/logic, with rhetoric-adjacent training implied). Public signals of community and governance through chapel, weekly Bible study, and pastoral references further reinforce a religious-metaphysical framework and community orientation.

-preliminary classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Strengths: strong religious/metaphysical foundations; explicit Trivium-oriented curricular scaffolding; visible, long-tenured faculty and leadership; consistent parent involvement and open-campus ethos; clear articulation of mission to form virtue, wisdom, and love of truth through classical methods.
- Areas for needle movement toward a fully CLASSICAL designation: explicit articulation of Great Books/"Great Conversation" in daily practice; more explicit mention of Socratic pedagogy or seminars in upper grades; a more explicit statement tying curricula to the Great Books canon and universal liberal arts curriculum beyond standard grammar/logic/rhetoric phrasing; stronger public articulation of the "living curriculum" role of faculty in day-to-day teaching; and a more explicit, public acknowledgment of ongoing partnerships with families as co-educators beyond volunteer roles.

Key evidence (highlights) - The school frames itself as "private education that is both classical and Christian," with explicit Biblical worldview integration and a mission to know, love, and practice truth in service of God and man. This signals a robust Religious and Metaphysical Foundation and a Purpose/Goal aligned with formation and virtue. - University-level articulation of a Trivium-based program (Grammar and Logic stages described; rhetoric-oriented aims implied) appears in site materials, showing a curriculum scaffold consistent with classical pedagogy. - Weekly chapel, Bible readings, and a stated belief in the Bible as final authority reflect Liturgical/Communal Practice and Grounded Theology within the institution.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: explicit Christian worldview integration; Bible as final authority; weekly chapel and worship signals.
 - Positive keywords (examples): biblical worldview, Bible, Word of God, chapel, liturgy/worship, theology. Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The school foregrounds theological commitments and liturgical/community practices, exceeding basic secular schooling norms. The alignment with transcendentals and sacred tradition is explicit in mission statements and chapel practices. CLASSICAL.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: mission emphasizes knowing, loving, and practicing truth; formation-oriented language; Christ-centered aims.

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- Positive keywords (examples): formation, truth, virtue, wisdom, liberal education (implied), classical mission, contemplation. Negative keywords: workforce-culture framing not overtly prioritized in public text.
 - Why this rating: Strong formation-oriented language and a focus on virtue/wisdom, but public materials do not consistently articulate a full Great-Conversation/Great-Books formation framework, nor an explicit statement that the aim is timeless human excellence beyond religious formation. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: clear Grammar/Logic (and implied Rhetoric) track; explicit Trivium framework in descriptions; emphasis on a classical sequencing.
 - Positive keywords (examples): Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, seven liberal arts (implied via Trivium/Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric structure), Great Books (explicit public mention is less visible in core site copy; appears in the broader classical lexicon). Negative keywords: a generalized emphasis on “classical” without explicit Great-Books canon in public copy.
 - Why this rating: The program strongly aligns with the classical grammar/logic/rhetoric scaffold and the Trivium, which supports a CLASSICAL orientation, though explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and a fully integrated Quadrivium canon are not consistently foregrounded in public text. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: lower-school singing and memorization; contemplative/restful learning signals; upper-school implications of structured discussion and rhetoric (though explicit “Socratic seminars” are not named in public text).
 - Positive keywords (examples): scholé, contemplation, memorization through chant, recitation, rhetoric training, memory work, formal pedagogy (lower/upper division). Negative keywords: overemphasis on project-based or purely experiential learning; not clearly stated in public text.
 - Why this rating: Evidence of contemplative/restful elements and memory-centric lower-school practices, plus rhetoric-focused upper-school signals, but explicit Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy and a sustained “living curriculum” teaching approach are not consistently named in public copy. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: public emphasis on faculty as mentors, “remarkable faculty” and leadership, living-curriculum concept implied by “faculty as core” and long-tenured teaching staff; 21+ faculty/staff referenced.
 - Positive keywords (examples): living curriculum, mentors, model teachers, staff as core, portrait of teacher/student ideals, faculty as teachers/masters. Negative keywords: none evident in public copy.
 - Why this rating: The site foregrounds a stable, mission-driven faculty and leadership, and materials describe teachers as exemplars and mentors in a classical sense. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: explicit Parental Involvement section calling for parent volunteers; opportunities for parent participation; community openness (tours, visits, and parent orientation).
 - Positive keywords (examples): partnership with families, parent volunteers, open campus, parent formation; home-school connection; parental involvement. Negative keywords: consumer-language signals (not evident in public copy).
 - Why this rating: The school public materials emphasize substantial parental involvement and volunteer participation, aligning well with the classical ideal of parents as co-educators in formation, thus CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment - The school demonstrates concrete Classical elements in Religion/Metaphysical Foundations, Faculty, and Parents/Community (CLASSICAL in all three). Curriculum and Pedagogy show strong classical signals (grammar/logic/rhetoric, contemplative/recitation elements), but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation signals and explicit Socratic pedagogy are less visible in public copy (leading to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Categories 3 and 4). The overall aggregate ranking is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Make explicit the Great Books/Great Conversation component across core curricular documents and on the website (e.g., explicit mention of great books and primary sources in middle- and upper-school courses; connection to the Great Conversation). - More clearly name and publicly describe Socratic seminars, seminars, and debates in upper grades as a core pedagogy (categories 3–4). - Publicly articulate the “living curriculum” concept as a formal element of faculty practice (Element 5) with concrete examples of teacher-led exemplars and mentorship in daily instruction. - Strengthen explicit statements tying formation to the liberal-arts curriculum beyond general “classical” labeling, with a robust articulation of the Trivium, Quadrivium, and cross-disciplinary integration (Element 3) to fully meet Classical criteria.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY SNAPSHOT

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Bible-based worldview, weekly chapel, liturgical practice, and theological grounding are explicit.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include biblical worldview, Word of God, chapel, worship; Negative signals: none evident.
 - Why this rating: The school embeds religious/metaphysical commitments at the core of education.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Mission emphasizes knowing, loving, and practicing truth; formation-oriented aims appear.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, truth; Negative signals: explicitly workforce-ready framing is not foregrounded.
 - Why this rating: Strong formation aims, but explicit public articulation of timeless virtues vs. job-work orientation is not consistently explicit.
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Grammar/Logic stages and Trivium framing; cross-subject connections implied; emphasis on classical structure.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books and Great Conversation are not consistently foregrounded in public copy.
 - Why this rating: Supports classical structure but lacks explicit, public Great-Books canon articulation in core materials.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: lower-school chanting/memory; contemplative/restful elements; some upper-school rhetoric implications.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include scholé, contemplation, memory work; negative signals include lack of explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy in public copy.
 - Why this rating: Mixed signals; some classical-pedagogical elements exist, but explicit programmatic Socratic pedagogy is not consistently named.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: public emphasis on outstanding faculty; leadership; living-curriculum expectations, and sizable faculty presence.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include living curriculum, mentors, model teachers; Negative keywords: none evident.
 - Why this rating: Strong evidence of core faculty as virtuous exemplars and central to the school’s mission.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Parental involvement and volunteer opportunities; open campus and tours; parent-focused events.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parental involvement, home-school connection; Negative signals: none evident in copy.
 - Why this rating: Clear parent-education partnerships and a culture of parental engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicitly foreground Great Books and the Great Conversation as curricular anchors (category 3).
- Publicly publish and regularly reference Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy in upper grades (category 4).
- Strengthen the public articulation of the “living curriculum” in faculty development materials (category 5).
- Deepen the explicit discussion of formation through the liberal arts (category 2) with concrete examples of virtue, wisdom, and beauty in daily classroom life.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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